

of accessibility during typing and another called the Number Keypad (or Numpad for short) exists on the very right which came in sort of as a legacy add-on for people involved in the number crunching business. Finally we have the Function keys F1 through F12 on the top and a few system keys like Esc, Caps lock etc. Laptops tend to do away with the Numpad to save space and to make it compact.

The standard keyboard that most of us use is said to have a QWERTY layout. By glancing at the top line of your keyboard you should be able to tell why. This arrangement is something that was derived from the age of using mechanical typewriters. They had levers which would spring forth for each key that you pressed and hit the centre of the paper. Now when more than one key was pressed at the same time two or more levers would come to strike the same place, though there was no reason for two simultaneous key presses there was the problem with rapid key presses. So to avoid the issue altogether keys that were bound to be used in succession were placed at opposite ends of the keyboard so that the levers had ample time to get out of each others' way.

Alternate layouts

Since keyboards don't have the problem with levers anymore people started experimenting with layouts and now a lot of such layouts exist. Most of these are regional, i.e. the standard QWERTY keyboard with regional lettering placed as an alternate option. The one that deserves a mention is the DVORAK keyboard named so after its inventor. Dr. August Dvorak noticed which keys were used the most frequently and came to the conclusion that typing mistakes tend to happen when people deviate from the home row, the home row is the row of alphabets in the middle, namely, ASDFGHJKL. So by taking the most commonly used alphabets and putting them all on the same row the typist doesn't have to move away from the home row and

